

Rooks need entry squares

Foundations

THE IDEA

Rooks move along ranks and files. An open file matters when it leads to a useful target or penetration square. Owning a file with no safe entry can be less valuable than defending a weakness on another file.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Imagine the d-file is open but d7 and d8 are heavily controlled. Doubling rooks there may look active yet achieve little. A preparatory move that removes a defender of d7 can turn file control into a real invasion.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you identify before doubling rooks on an open file?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Name an entry square, the opponent's defenders of it, and the target after entry. If none exists, compare the file operation with improving your worst piece.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

File control is a means; penetration is the purpose.